

Checklist for common criteria for UX

Term 2 Week 2

NB !!!

**Not all of them apply to all kinds of products,
but generally the following are the ones that are most relevant**



Section 1: Interaction Design

1. Repetitive actions or frequent activities feel effortless:

WHY: It matters because repetitive actions for the same output (for example, filling different forms with the same information) is a strenuous task that doesn't help the user achieve his or her goals faster or better

ACTION: If repetitive actions are present, have an option to use previously entered information



2. Users can easily recover from errors:

WHY: Users perform unintended actions that lead to undesired results.
Allowing them to go back and try again means they won't be frustrated

ACTION: Make sure that your navigation system allows for going back

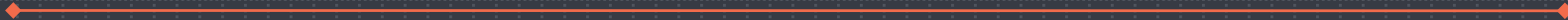
Section 1: Interaction Design

3. Accessing help does not impede user progress:

WHY: Users ask for help whenever they are stuck in a certain part of your product.

It is important for help – online or offline – to be additional
and allow the user to resume work where they left off

Testing ACTION: Create test scenarios where users will ask for help,
and see whether their work flows and progress are interrupted



Section 2: Visual Design

1. Color alone is not used to convey hierarchy, content or functionality:

WHY: Having a product that is accessible is not a plus – it's a must.

For people with visual disabilities, such as color blindness, relying solely on color to convey hierarchy, content or functionality means they will not be able to use your product and will be an excluded demograph

ACTION: colorfilter.wickline.org will let you put a color filter on top of your webpage and test it for different kinds of color blindnesses



2. Items on top of the visual hierarchy are the most important:

WHY: Visual hierarchy allows users to quickly scan information, prioritizing content based on their immediate needs. Items near the top of the visual hierarchy must be most important to the business and most relevant for users

ACTION: View your digital product on Screen and squint so that thing being just blurred or if you have access to photoshop, Gaussian Blur the content and looking at the result, you'll instantly be able to visualize the hierarchy and notice which elements stand out

Section 2: Visual Design

3. Primary action is visually distinct from secondary actions:

WHY: Having distinct primary and secondary actions means the user won't be confused when interacting with your product and will be less prone to making mistakes.

For example, "Submit" (**PRIMARY**) and "Cancel" (**SECONDARY**) must be clearly distinct

ACTION: When reviewing the design, make sure that color, size, positioning and other elements differentiate the actions



4. Form submission is confirmed in a visually distinct manner:

WHY: It is essential to give the user confirmation of whether an action was successfully performed or not. This becomes very important when **Help related forms** or **E-Commerce** is involved.

ACTION: During testing, trigger a confirmation regarding whether that action was successful or not. Make sure the feedback is crystal clear regarding the end status

Section 2: Visual Design

5. Alert messages are consistent:

WHY: Alert messages have the same visual style and appear in the same location in the same manner

ACTION: Having consistent alert messages means the user will always understand what immediately deserves attention



6. Alert messages are visually distinct:

WHY: By making sure that alert messages are clearly differentiated from other screen elements, the user can actually notice and act on them

ACTION: After checking for visual differentiation yourself, Provide users with a few distinct alert messages and judge how they react to the various alert messages during testing

Section 3: Information Architecture

1. Navigation is consistent:

WHY: The way users orient and then navigate through your product directly influences whether they can complete their goals regardless of where they are with the product

ACTION: During testing, try tree testing (hierarchy) to ensure your information architecture pathways are as intuitive as possible



2. Room for growth:

WHY: You can't redesign a product's navigation system every time new features are added. Navigation menus and the overall layout needs to support more categories without breaking. Designing with room for growth means that major design and development efforts scale easily across the interface

ACTION: During Design Phases, Ask all involved with decision making, how content might grow over time in the product i.e. Will you support more static content? Will the information architecture need to support videos?

Section 4: Typography

1. No more than two distinct font families are used:

WHY: It isn't a fixed rule.

For usability/visual purposes, sticking to two simplifies your typographic hierarchy, which improves comprehension

ACTION: During testing, try combining 2 distinct families and then add a 3rd and gauge how users respond



2. Reserve uppercase words for labels, headers, or acronyms:

WHY: Limiting the use of uppercase words is known to facilitate understanding
It should be used specifically for emphasis

ACTION: Before general testing, run a thorough content check

Section 4: Typography

3. Different font styles are used to separate content from controls:

WHY: There needs to be clear indicators as to what is content and what are controls

ACTION: Identify all controls in your product and make sure that they are standing out from the content.
When running usability tests, pay attention to whether users are having difficulties interacting with controls



4. Font size/weight differentiates between content types:

WHY: It heavily impacts readability and comprehension.
Making a clear distinction between headings, subheadings and from paragraphs reduces the mental overload in digesting that content

ACTION: When reviewing the content inside your product, make sure that headings, subheadings and paragraphs are using different font sizes and weights